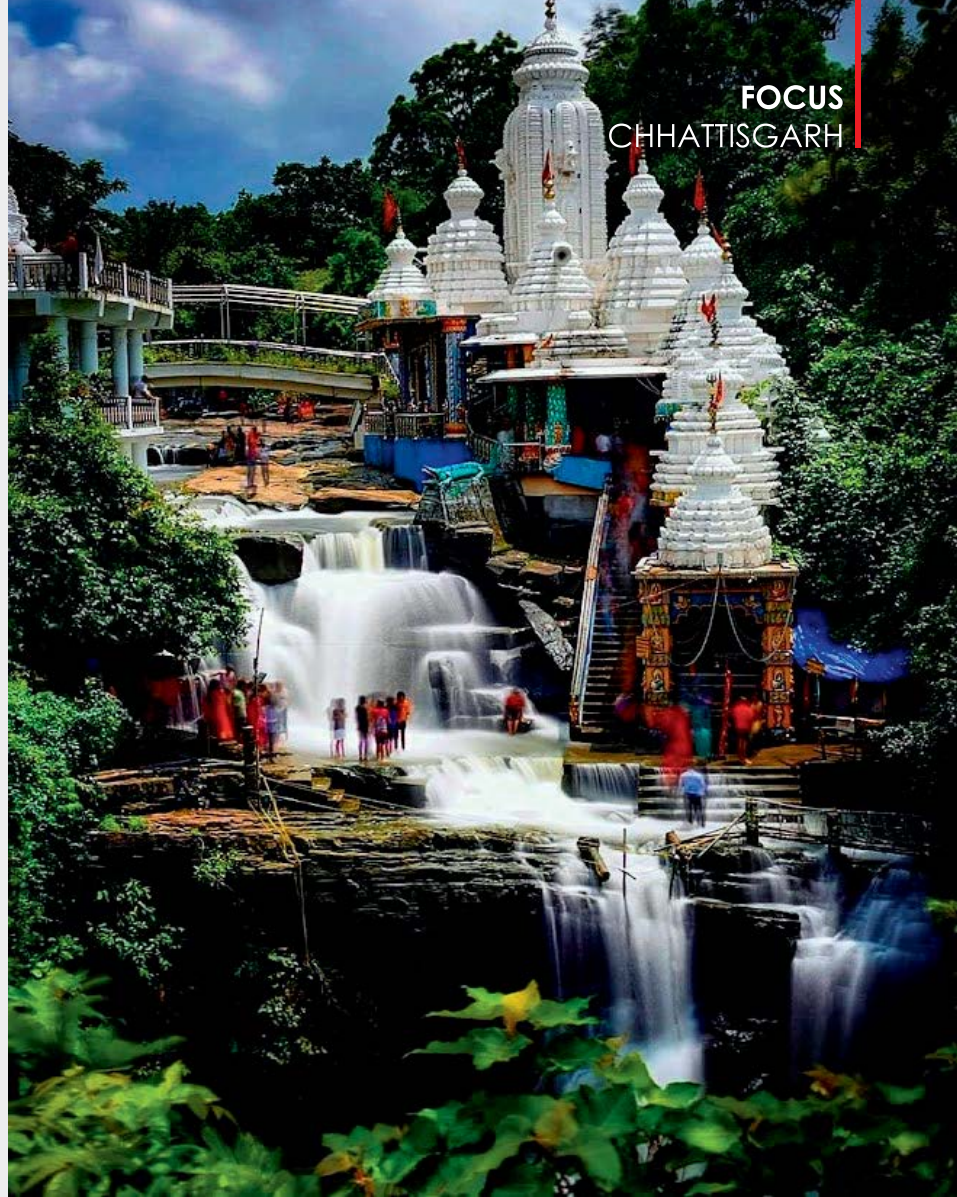


Purnima to Amavasya every year.

**Chandkhuri** is a small village located 27 Km. away from the state capital Raipur and is considered to be the birthplace of Lord Ram's mother Mata Kaushalya. Chandkhuri has the honour of being home to the only temple in the world dedicated to Mata Kaushalya, which has a rare idol of Kaushalya holding her son Ram in her arms. Highlighting the benefits of the development work at Chandkhuri, CM Baghel said, "Last year, we undertook beautification work of Chandkhuri which is 28 km away from Raipur, the capital. An ancient Mata Kaushalya temple is located there which was renovated last year. Today, a large number of people visit this place every weekend. It has now become a tourism spot and also an 'aastha kendra' (centre of devotion)."

**Rajim (Gariyaband)** is a holy town situated at the confluence of three rivers- Pairi, Mahanadi, and Sondur earning the moniker Prayagraj of Chhattisgarh. It is a prominent spot of religious tourism in Chhattisgarh that attracts visitors from all over the world. Rajim is a paradise for tourists seeking a religious experience as it is home to some of the most famous temples in the state like Rajiv Lochan Temple, Ramachandra Temple, Dhaneshwar Temple, Kuleshwar Temple, and Mahamaya Temple. The ideal time to visit Rajim for sightseeing is during winter season.

**Saptarishi ashram** in Dhamtari district has interesting links to the Hindu sages. According to legends, this village, located 80 Km. away from Dhamtari, had the Ashrams of the seven sages or Saptrishi built on different hills. Sihawa has the Ashram of the sage Shringhi, who was invited by King Dashrath in Ayodhya to conduct the Putrayeshti Yagya. This makes Sihawa a crucial spot for religious and cultural tourism in Chhattisgarh. Interestingly, it was sage Shringi's disciple Mahanand after whom the river Mahanadi is named, therefore, Sihawa is known to be the point of origin of the massive river



Mahanadi, which is the oldest river of central and east India, and empties into the Bay of Bengal. Dalpat Reservoir Jagdalpur or Dalpat Sagar Lake in Bastar is known for its virgin beauty and subtle charm flocked by awestruck tourists. It is known to have been constructed about 400 years ago during the

reign of Raja Dalpat Deo Kakatiya for the purpose of conserving water. A small island in the middle of the lake is a centre of attraction consisting of beautiful resorts and parks that mesmerises all visitors, alike. The state government has also provided facilities for motor boating and fishing and is favourite picnic spot for local people serving as a weekend escape from the chaos of city life. Dalpat Reservoir is just 4 Km. away from Jagdalpur and is easily accessible through road and railways.

**Ramaram** is a small village in Sukma district that is named after Lord Ram. If legends are to be believed, it has a hill that bears the footmarks of Shri Ram. It is also known to be the last destination of Lord Ram in Chhattisgarh. Ramaram hosts a vibrant fair every year during Ramnavami, which is worth not giving a miss. The project dedicated to the memories of Lord Ram is envisaged to achieve phenomenal success in securing Chhattisgarh a place on the global map as a destination for religious tourism. The places shortlisted for development under the project are approachable by road, train and in some places like Raipur, Jagdalpur with an airport.

